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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCAGD100 - HISTORY OF ART AND DESIGN

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours Maximum Marks: 50

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I), Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

Students should attempt atleast one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

[Learning Domain][CO No(s)]

Part A
Short Answer Questions
Answer any 5 out of 7 questions
Each question carries 2 marks

1. Name the two major rivers that define the region of Mesopotamia. [K] [2]

Tigris and Euphrates

2. Identify the main advancements in printing technology during the Victorian era and their impact on graphic design. [U] [4]

During the Victorian era, several advancements in printing technology revolutionized graphic design:

- Lithography and Chromolithography:
- Steam-powered Printing Press.
- Wood Engraving:

3. Define why Altamira Cave is referred to as the 'Sistine Chapel of Prehistoric Art.' [U] [1]

Altamira Cave in Spain is called the 'Sistine Chapel of Prehistoric Art' because of its exceptional Paleolithic paintings, which depict vivid images of bison, horses, and other animals. The artwork demonstrates advanced artistic techniques, such as the use of natural pigments, shading for a

three-dimensional effect, and an understanding of perspective, which was ground breaking for its time.

4. Write a note on any two Impressionist artists. [K] [3]

- Claude Monet: Renowned as a founder of Impressionism, Monet focused on capturing light and atmosphere. His series paintings, such as Water Lilies and Impression, Sunrise, exemplify the Impressionist style with loose brushwork and vibrant colors.
- Edgar Degas: Known for his depictions of dancers, Degas blended Impressionist techniques with a focus on human form and movement. Works like The Ballet Class showcase his interest in perspective, light, and the dynamism of modern life.

5. Write about the significance of engraving in the history of printmaking. [A] [4]

- Artistic Reproduction
- Detail and Precision:.
- Cultural Impact:

6. Identify the Renaissance artist famous for the Mona Lisa and The Last Supper. [K] [2]

The Renaissance artist famous for the Mona Lisa and The Last Supper is Leonardo da Vinci. He is celebrated for his mastery of anatomy, perspective, and use of sfumato, which created lifelike and emotionally resonant works.

7. State the primary artistic style of M.F. Husain. [K] [3]

The primary artistic style of Maqbool Fida Husain (M.F. Husain) is Modern Indian Art, characterized by bold lines, simplified forms, and vibrant colors. His work often incorporated themes from Indian culture, mythology, and contemporary issues, blending traditional Indian motifs with modernist aesthetics.

$(5 \times 2 = 10)$

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any 5 out of 7 questionsEach question carries 5 marks

8. Write a short note on Cubism with examples. [K] [3]

Cubism was an influential 20th-century art movement pioneered by Pablo Picasso and Georges Braque. It emphasized abstract forms, geometric shapes, and the deconstruction of objects into fragmented, multi-dimensional views.

- Analytical Cubism (1908-1912): Focused on breaking objects into facets, as seen in Picasso's Les Demoiselles d'Avignon.
- Synthetic Cubism (1912-1914): Incorporated collaged elements, like Braque's Fruit Dish and Glass.
  Cubism reshaped modern art by challenging traditional perspective and representation.

9. Compare the religious symbolism in the Buddhist caves at Ajanta with the Hindu caves at Ellora. [An] [1]

- Ajanta Caves: These predominantly Buddhist caves depict the life and teachings of Buddha through frescoes and sculptures. Symbols like the lotus, Bodhi tree, and wheel convey spiritual ideas of enlightenment and dharma.
- Ellora Caves: The Hindu caves celebrate deities like Shiva, Vishnu, and Durga through grand sculptures, such as the Kailasa Temple, which symbolizes Mount Kailash.
  Comparison: Ajanta emphasizes introspective spirituality and the path to enlightenment, while Ellora's Hindu caves display cosmic myths, divine power, and dynamic energy, reflecting the differing religious philosophies.

10. Describe the painting styles used by Expressionist artists. [K] [3]

Expressionist artists used vivid colors, distorted forms, and exaggerated brushstrokes to evoke emotional responses and depict inner turmoil.

- Styles:
  - German Expressionism: Focused on themes of alienation and anxiety, as seen in Edvard Munch's The Scream.
  - Abstract Expressionism: Emphasized bold, non-representational forms, like Wassily Kandinsky's Composition VII.
  - Figurative Expressionism: Combined realism with emotional intensity, as in Egon Schiele's works.
    Expressionists prioritized emotional truth over realistic representation.

11. Explain the technological advancements made in printing from the Renaissance to the Industrial Revolution. [U] [4]

- Renaissance (15th–16th centuries):

    - Gutenberg Press (1440s): Enabled movable type printing, revolutionizing book production.
    - Engraving and Etching: Allowed for intricate illustrations in books.
- Industrial Revolution (18th–19th centuries):
    - Steam-powered Printing Press: Increased printing speed and lowered costs.
    - Lithography: Enabled colorful and detailed prints.
    - Mass Production of Newspapers and Posters: Improved accessibility to printed material, enhancing literacy and communication.
      These advancements democratized knowledge and transformed publishing and visual culture.

12. Evaluate Leonardo da Vinci's contributions to both art and science during the Renaissance. [E] [2]

Leonardo da Vinci epitomized the Renaissance ideal of the polymath.

- Art: His works, like Mona Lisa and The Last Supper, showcased innovations in perspective, anatomy, and sfumato. He elevated portraiture and religious scenes to new levels of emotional depth and technical precision.
- Science: Leonardo's notebooks reveal his contributions to anatomy, engineering, botany, and hydraulics. His sketches of flying machines, human anatomy, and water systems were ahead of his time, bridging art and scientific inquiry.
  Leonardo's integration of artistic and scientific practices remains unparalleled, influencing generations.

13. Examine the impact of social media on Internet usage. [An] [4]

Social media has dramatically reshaped Internet usage by:

- Increasing Connectivity: Platforms like Facebook and Instagram enable instant global communication.
- Driving Content Consumption: Users spend significant time on apps consuming videos, news, and entertainment.
- Shaping E-commerce: Social media integrates shopping features, altering consumer behavior.
- Raising Concerns: It contributes to issues like misinformation, privacy breaches, and addiction.
  Social media has become integral to digital life, influencing how people interact, learn, and work online.

14. Examine the conservation challenges faced by the Altamira Cave paintings and the efforts made to preserve them. [An] [1]

The Altamira Cave paintings face challenges like:

- Environmental Damage: Visitor-induced humidity and carbon dioxide caused microbial growth.
- Aging and Natural Erosion: Paintings created 20,000 years ago are vulnerable to flaking and fading.

Preservation Efforts:

- Limiting public access and creating replicas
- Monitoring environmental conditions within the cave.
- Using advanced imaging to document and study the art.
  These efforts balance public interest with the preservation of this cultural treasure.

(5 × 5 = 25)

Part C
Essay Type
Questions Answer
any 1 question
Each question carries 15
marks

15.Illustrate how Social Changes During the Victorian Era,such as urbanization and Industrialization ,were Reflected in the era's Graphic Design [A] [4]

1. Urbanization and Typography

- The rapid growth of cities created bustling urban centers filled with advertisements for goods and services.
- Impact on Design:
  - Designers developed bold, elaborate typefaces to stand out in crowded urban landscapes.
  - Street signs, posters, and advertisements featured ornate letterforms, often embellished with flourishes and shadows.
  - Public notices and shopfronts utilized visually striking designs to attract attention in busy city streets.

2. Industrialization and Technological Advances

- The Industrial Revolution introduced new printing technologies like lithography and chromolithography, enabling mass production of colorful prints.
- Impact on Design:
  - Graphic design became more accessible and affordable, catering to an expanding middle-class audience.
  - Vivid advertisements for consumer goods filled posters, trade cards, and magazines, reflecting the era's consumer culture.
  - Machine-made embellishments: Intricate patterns and repetitive motifs, inspired by mechanical production, were common in packaging and design.

3. Social Values and Morality

- Victorian society upheld strict moral and aesthetic values, which designers incorporated into their work.
- Impact on Design:
    - Decorative elements like floral motifs, borders, and allegorical imagery conveyed ideas of refinement and virtue.
    - Themes of family, industry, and progress were common in both advertisements and book illustrations.

4. Printed Media and Mass Communication

- Urbanization fueled a demand for newspapers, magazines, and books, as literacy rates improved and the press became more widespread.
- Impact on Design:
    - Illustrated publications became popular, featuring detailed wood engravings and decorative layouts.
    - Serialized novels and affordable printed materials like penny dreadfuls catered to the growing literate urban population.

5. Advertising and Consumer Culture

- The industrialized economy produced a wide array of goods, leading to fierce competition and the need for effective advertising.
- Impact on Design:
    - Colorful posters and trade cards promoted products like soaps, teas, and machinery, blending eye-catching visuals with persuasive text.
    - Brand identity began to emerge, with companies using graphic design to create recognizable logos and packaging.

16. Write a detailed description on the Art of Egyptian Civilization [A] [2]

1. General Characteristics

- Art was deeply connected to religion, power, and the afterlife.
- Emphasis on symbolism, order, and permanence, reflecting their belief in cosmic harmony
- Use of hierarchical scale, where the size of a figure indicated its importance.

2. Architecture

- Pyramids: Grand tombs, such as the Pyramids of Giza, symbolizing eternal life and royal power.
- Temples: Massive structures like Karnak and Luxor, dedicated to gods with intricate carvings and hypostyle halls.

3. Sculpture

- Statues of pharaohs, deities, and animals, often rigid and frontal, representing strength and divine power.

- Materials like stone, gold, and bronze were used for durability and symbolic meaning.

4. Paintings and Reliefs

- Found on tomb walls, depicting daily life, religious rituals, and the afterlife.
- Figures were shown in a composite view: heads and legs in profile, torsos facing forward.
- Use of natural pigments with flat, bright colors and little shading.

5. Decorative Arts

- Jewelry and Amulets: Richly adorned with gold, turquoise, and lapis lazuli, symbolizing protection and status.
- Papyrus Scrolls: Illustrated manuscripts like the Book of the Dead featuring detailed imagery and text.

6. Symbolism in Art

- Ankh: Symbol of life.
- Lotus and Papyrus: Represented Upper and Lower Egypt.
- Colors: Each color held meaning (e.g., green for fertility, gold for divinity).

7. Artistic Techniques

- Precision and adherence to strict artistic conventions ensured consistency over millennia.
- Mastery in stone carving, relief work, and painting with natural pigments.

17.Recall the evolution of Indian painting from traditional to modern [K] [3]

- Ancient and Classical Period:
  - Cave Paintings (Ajanta, Ellora): Buddhist themes, narratives, and intricate frescoes.
  - Miniature Paintings (Mughal, Rajput): Detailed and vibrant depictions of court life, mythology, and nature.
- Medieval Period:
  - Pahari and Deccan Schools: Regional variations, blending local themes with Persian influences.
  - Tanjore Paintings: Rich gold-foil techniques and devotional themes.
- Colonial Period:
  - Company Style: European techniques combined with Indian themes for documentation.
  - Raja Ravi Varma: Introduced realism and oil painting, depicting Indian mythology in a Westernized style.
- Modern Period (Post-Independence):
  - Bengal School (Abanindranath Tagore): Revival of traditional Indian styles with modern sensibilities.
  - Progressive Artists' Group (M.F. Husain, F.N. Souza): Abstract, bold, and experimental approaches reflecting contemporary themes.

- Contemporary Indian Art: A mix of global influences and local identity, seen in installation art, digital mediums, and socially relevant works.

(1 × 15 = 15)

END OF THE QUESTION PAPER

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